

**Carnegie  
Mellon  
University**



# Towards Foundational Models for Single-Chip Radar

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**ICCV 2025**

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*<sup>1</sup>Carnegie Mellon University, <sup>2</sup>Bosch Research, <sup>3</sup>University of Wisconsin-Madison*

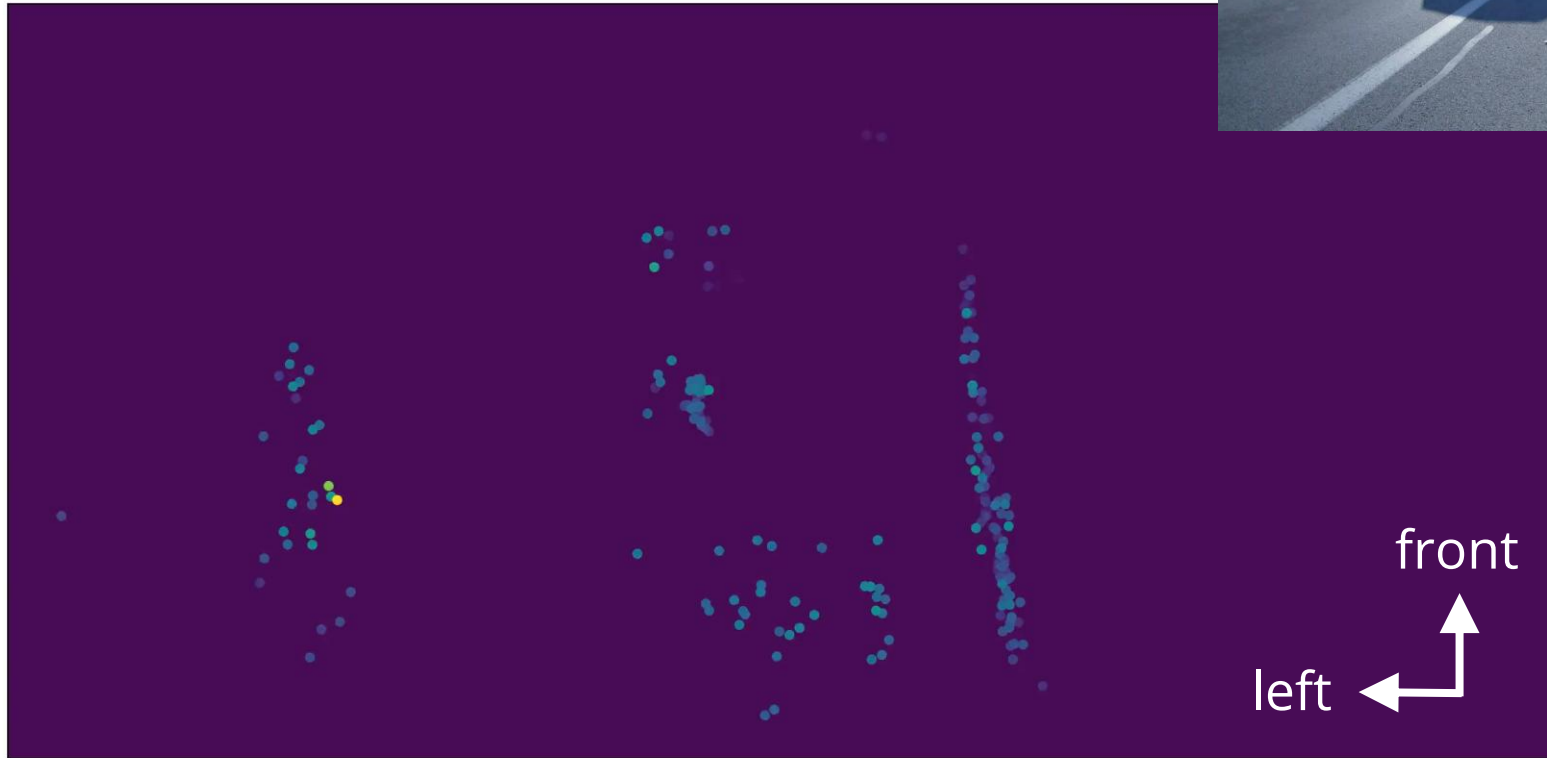


In this talk: **we turn this...**

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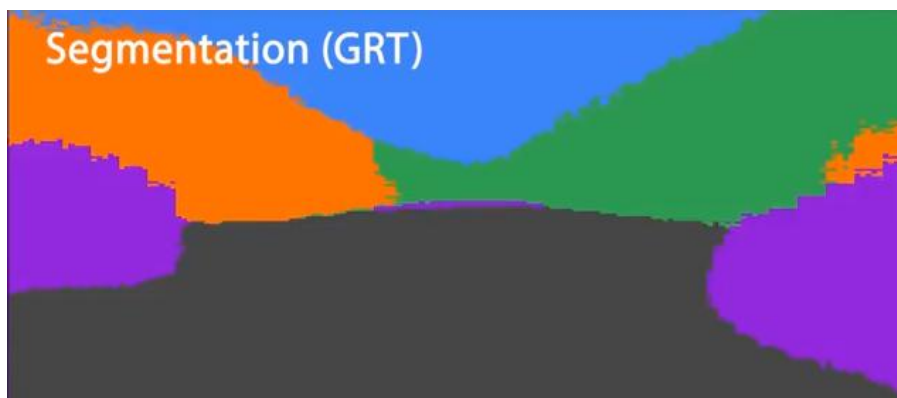


camera  
reference

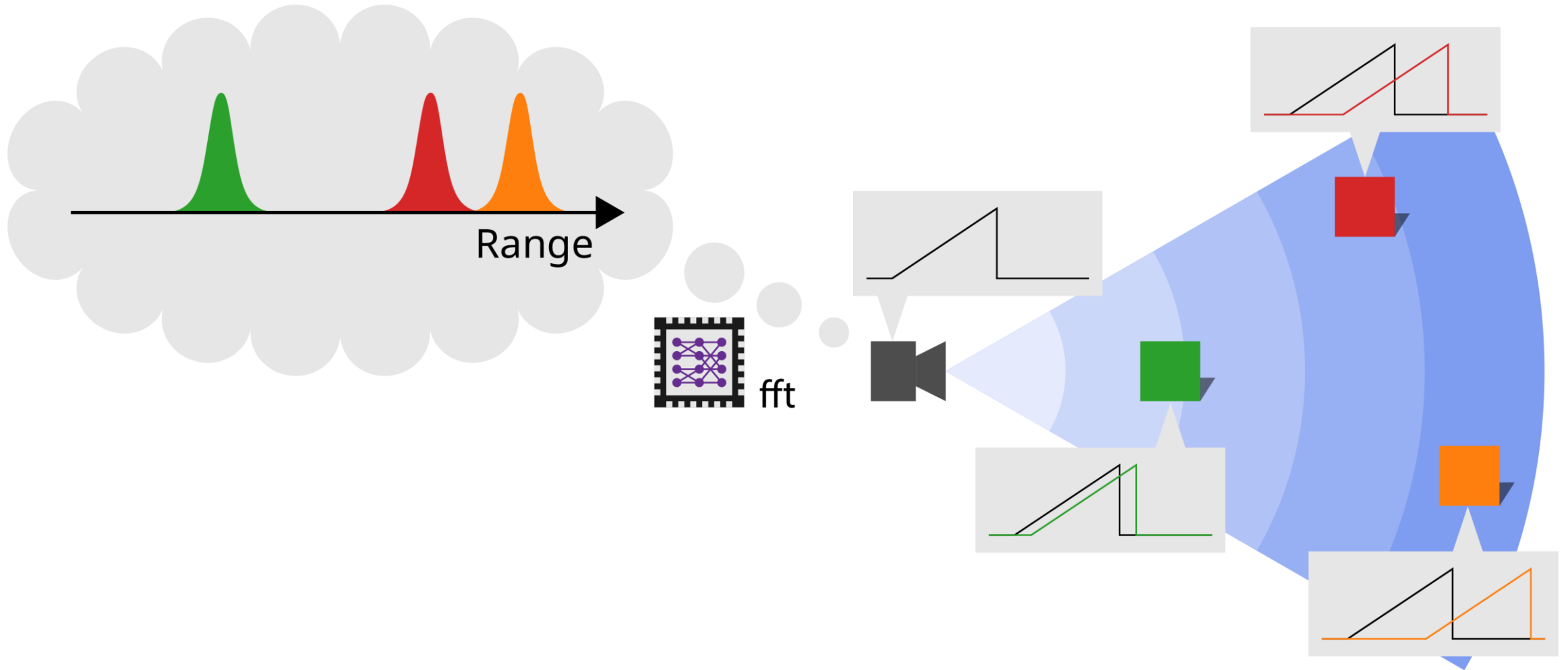


... into this

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# Radar: Time of Flight Ranging





# Why Radar?

## Radar vs Cameras



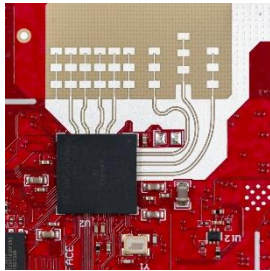
# Why Radar?

## Radar vs Lidar

\$

\$\$

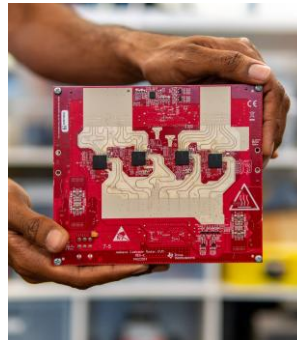
\$\$\$+



# Single-Chip Radar



## Cameras



## Imaging Radar

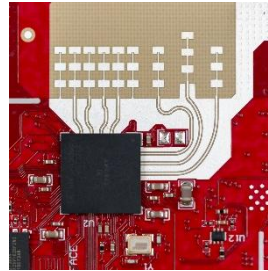


FMCW  
Lidar



## Traditional Lidar

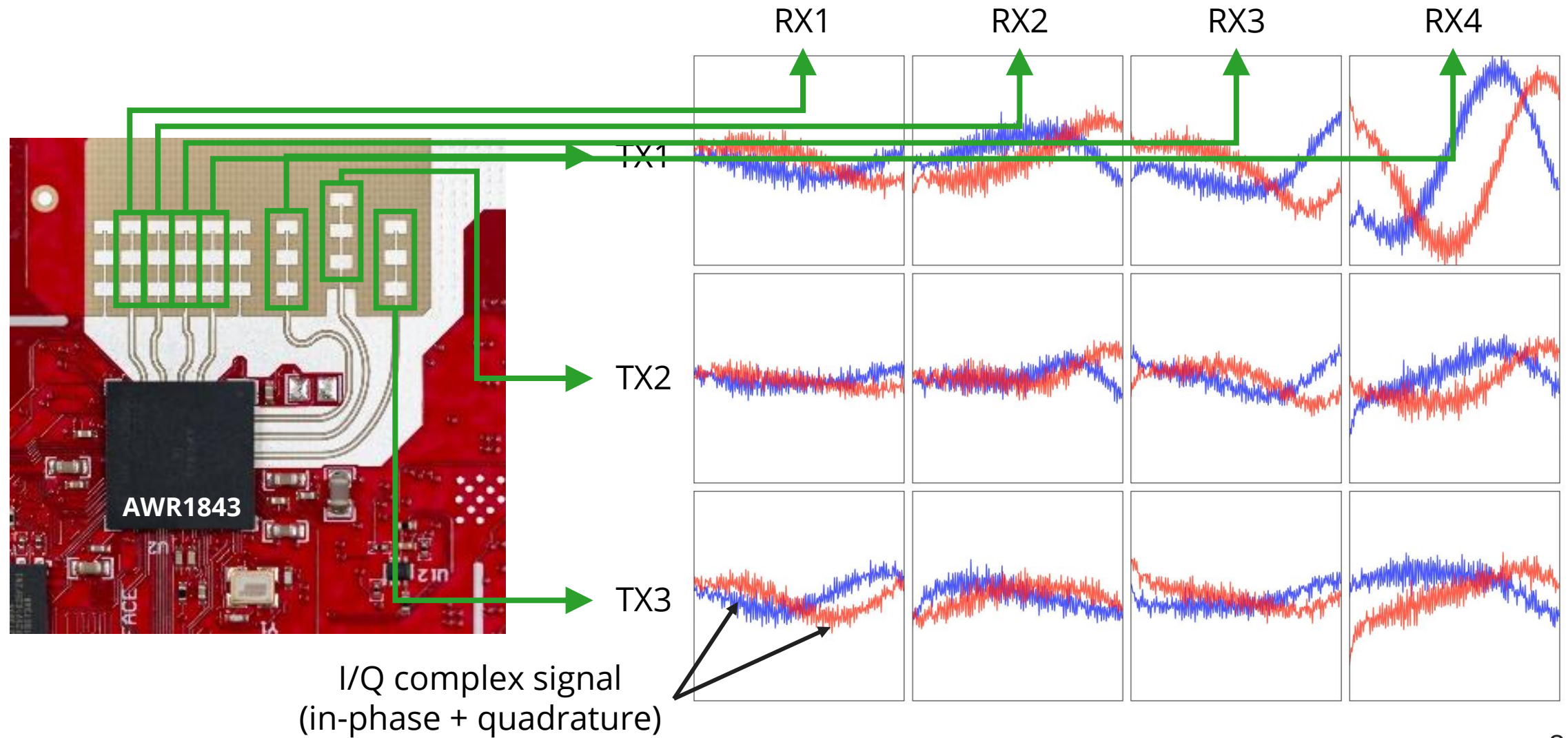
# Why Radar?



|                         | Radar  | Camera | Lidar      |
|-------------------------|--------|--------|------------|
| Angular Ambiguity       | X High | ✓ Low  | ✓ Low      |
| Spatial Resolution      | X Low  | ✓ High | ✓ High     |
| Range Ambiguity         | ✓ Low  | X High | ✓ Low      |
| Works in the Dark       | ✓ Yes  | X No   | ✓ Yes      |
| Robustness to Occlusion | ✓ High | X Low  | X Moderate |
| Cost                    | \$     | \$     | \$\$\$     |

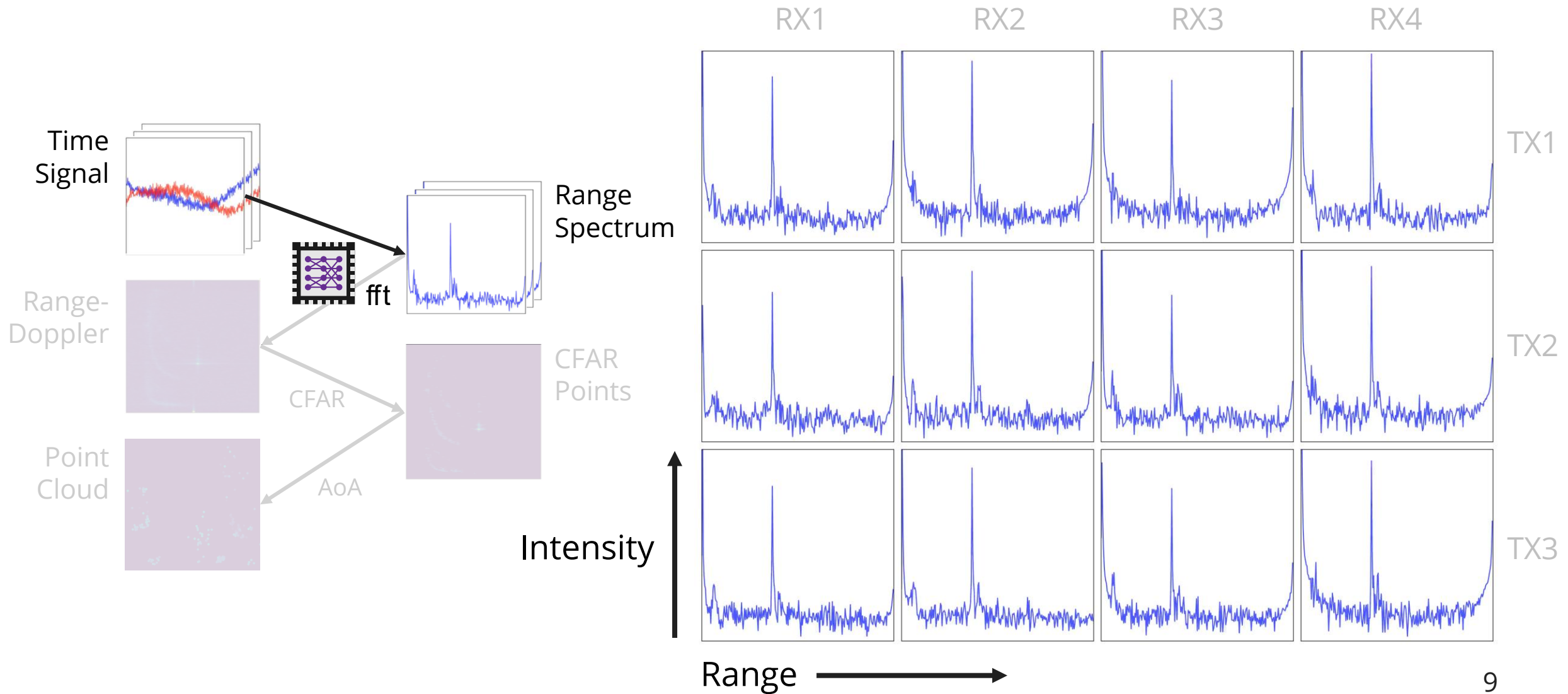


# Radar Processing: **Time Signal**

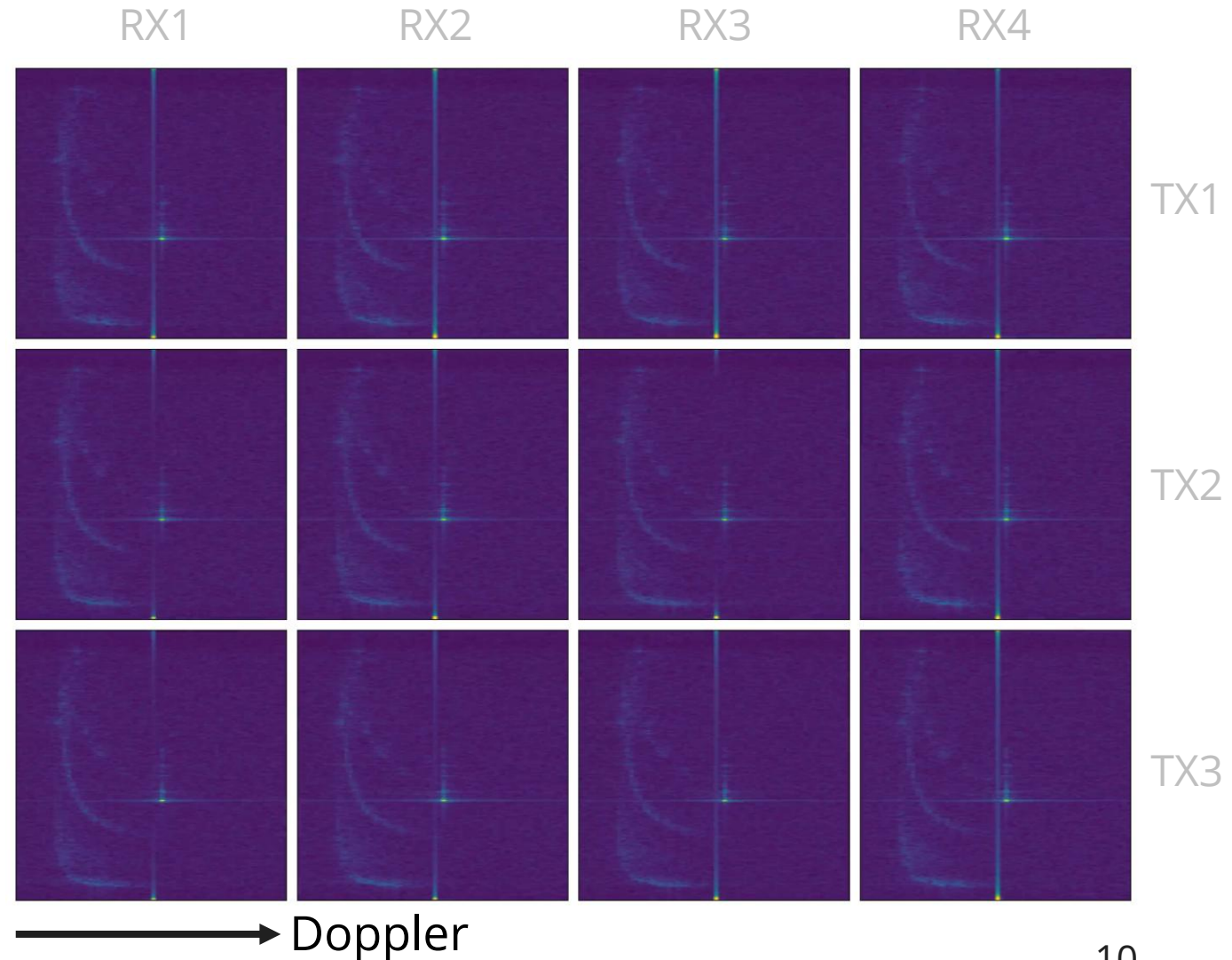
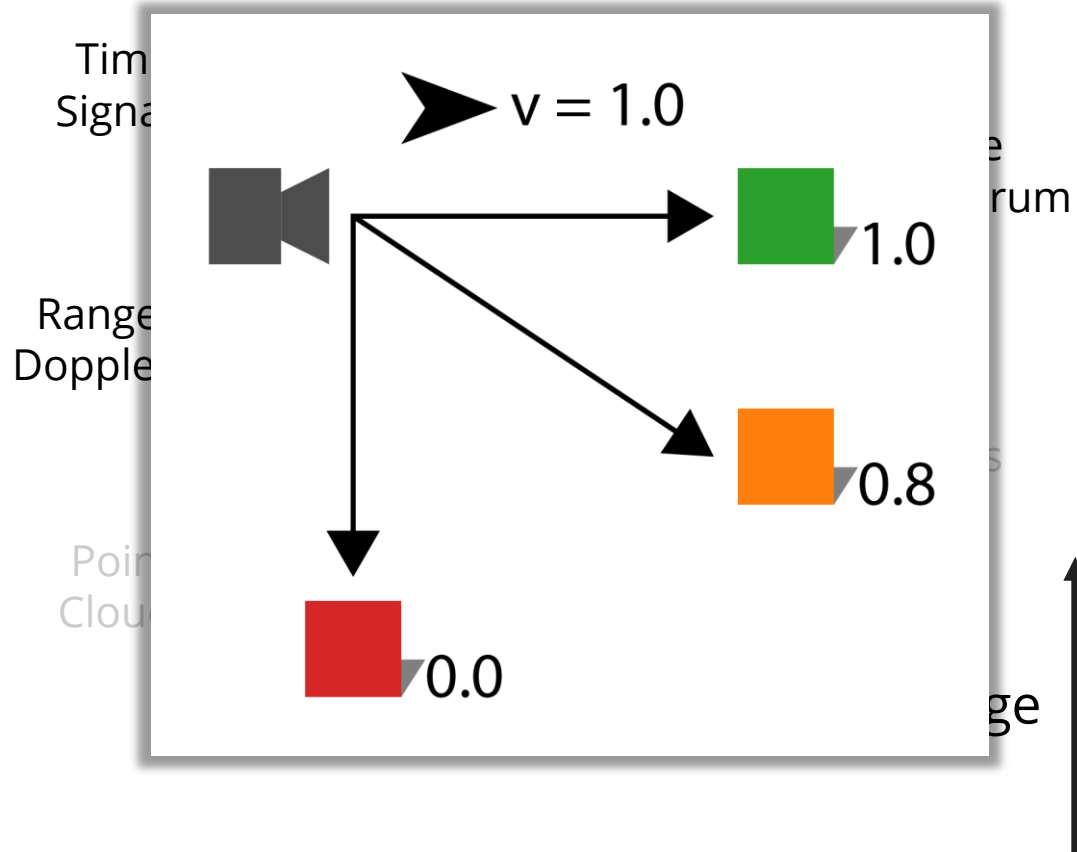




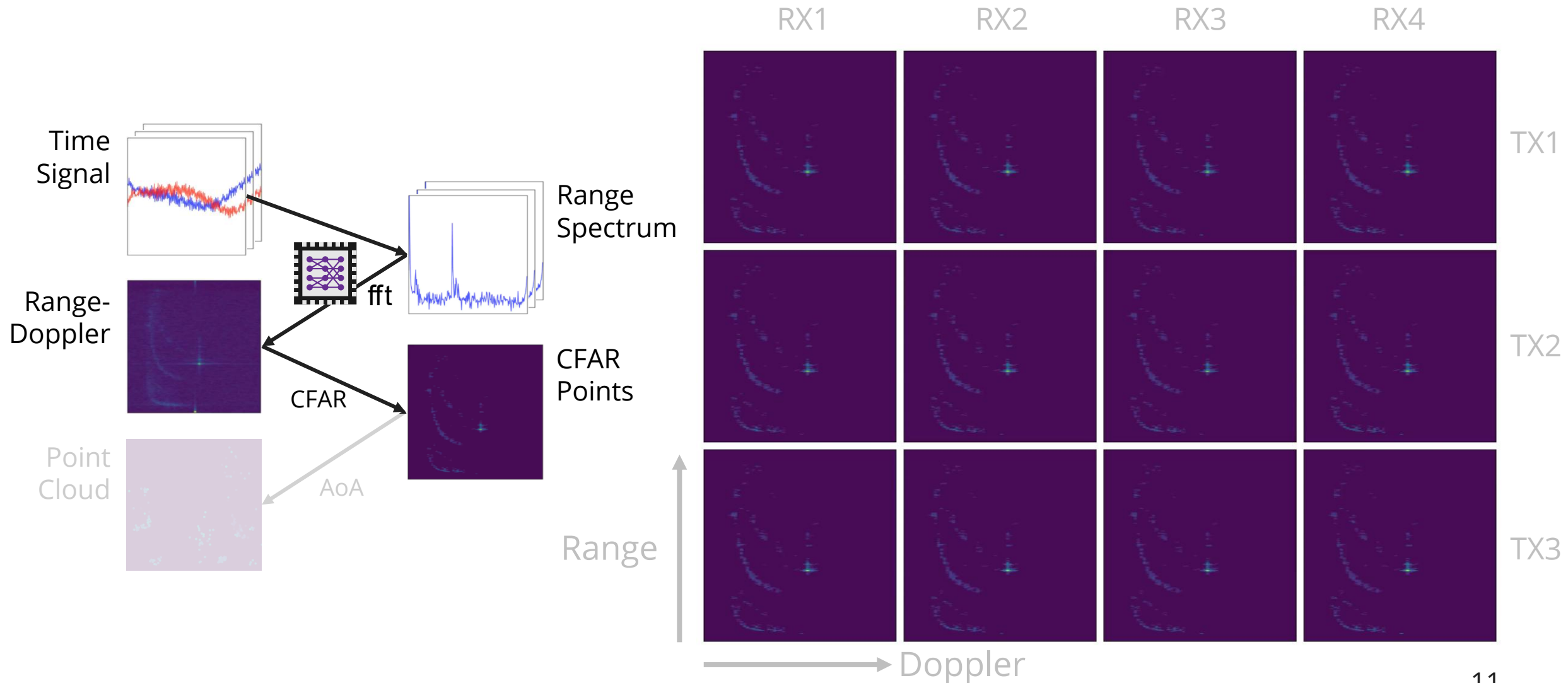
# Radar Processing: Range Spectrum



# Radar Processing: Range-Doppler Spectrum

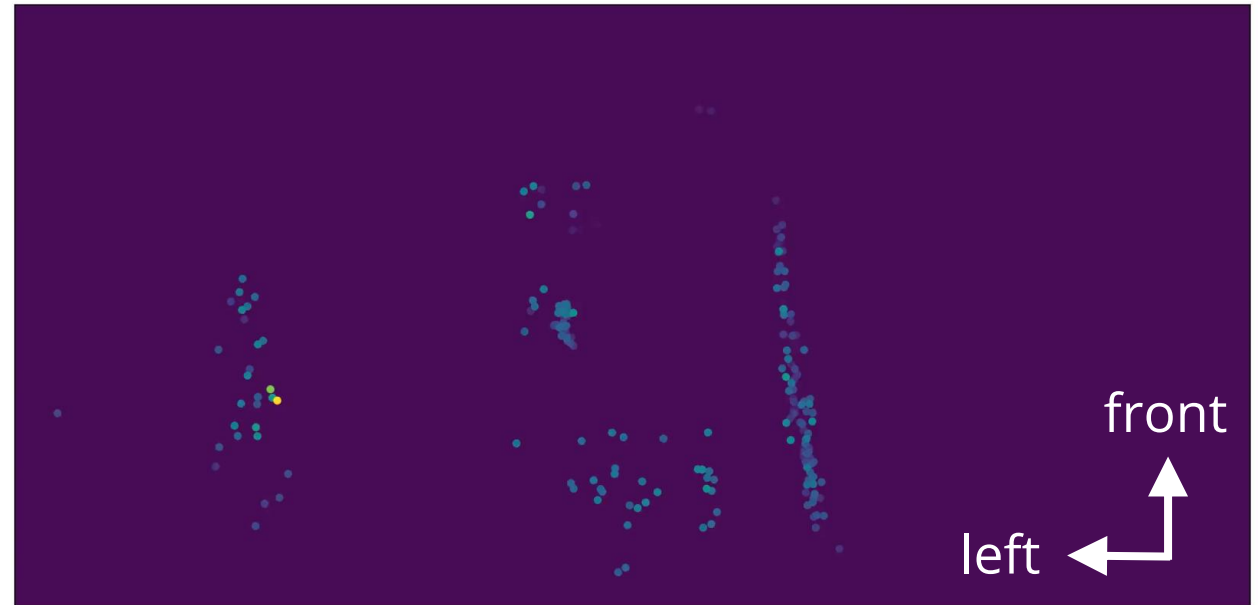
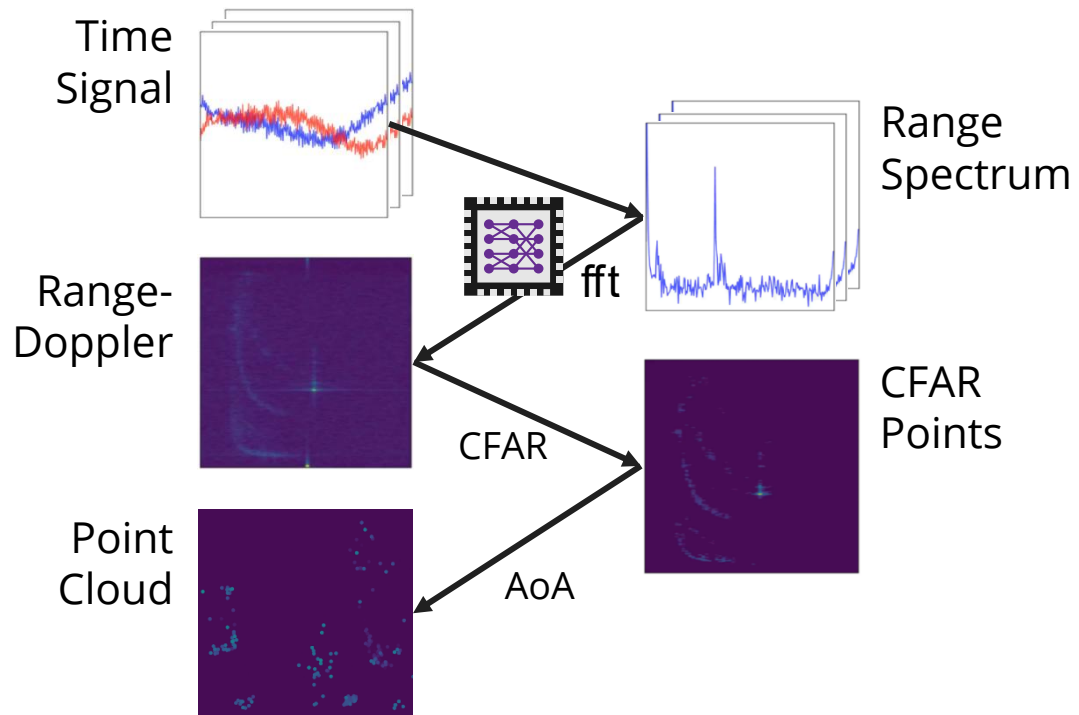


# Radar Processing: CFAR Peak Detection





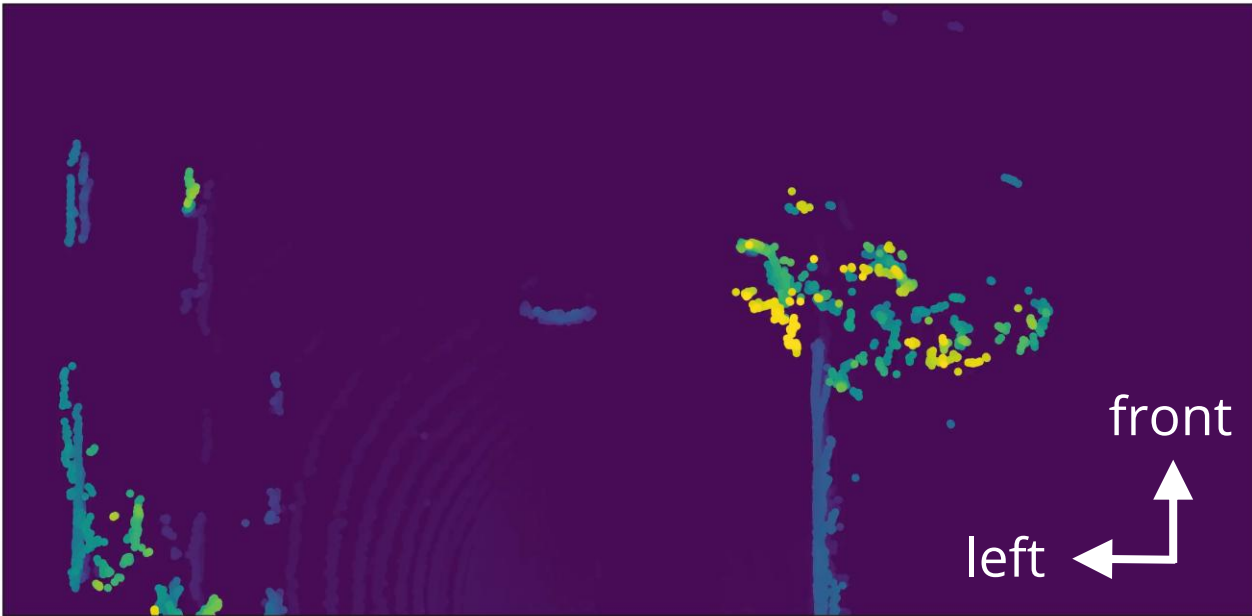
# Radar Processing: **Angle of Arrival Estimation**



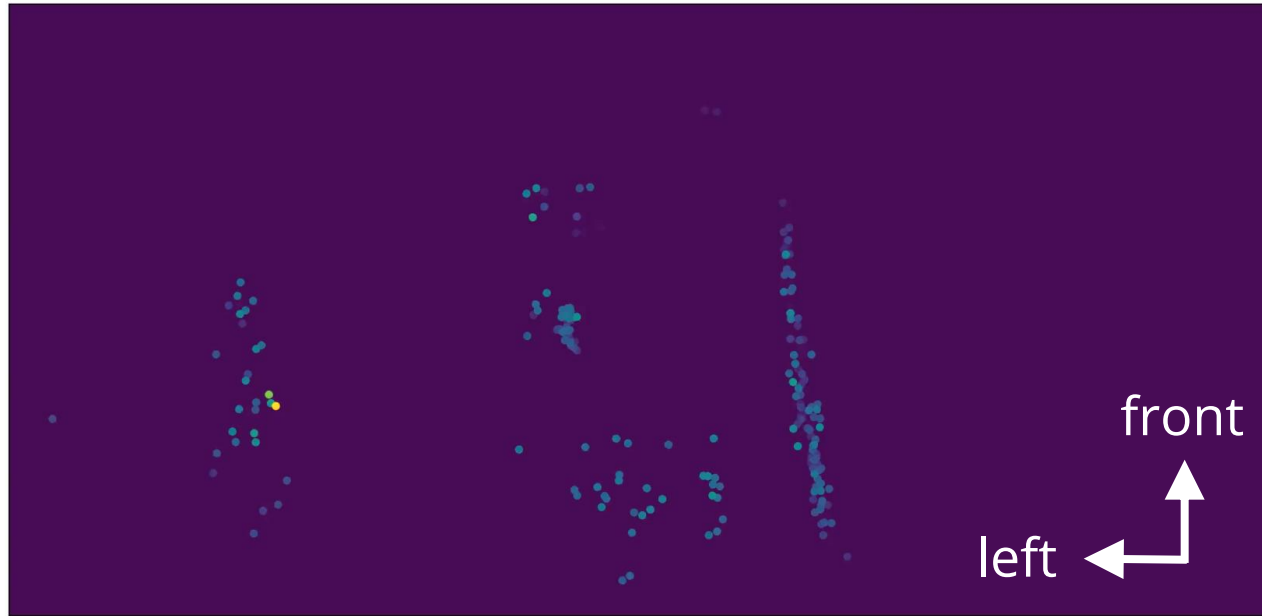
# Radar Point Clouds

## Poor Resolution & Low Density

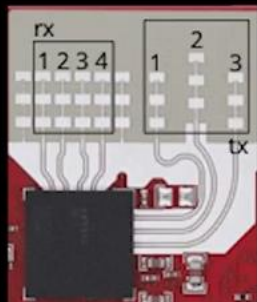
**lidar**



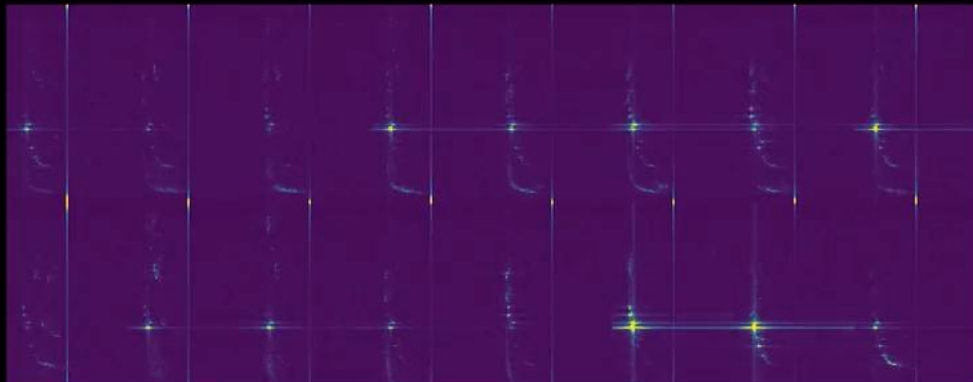
**radar**



## Input: 4D Radar Spectrum



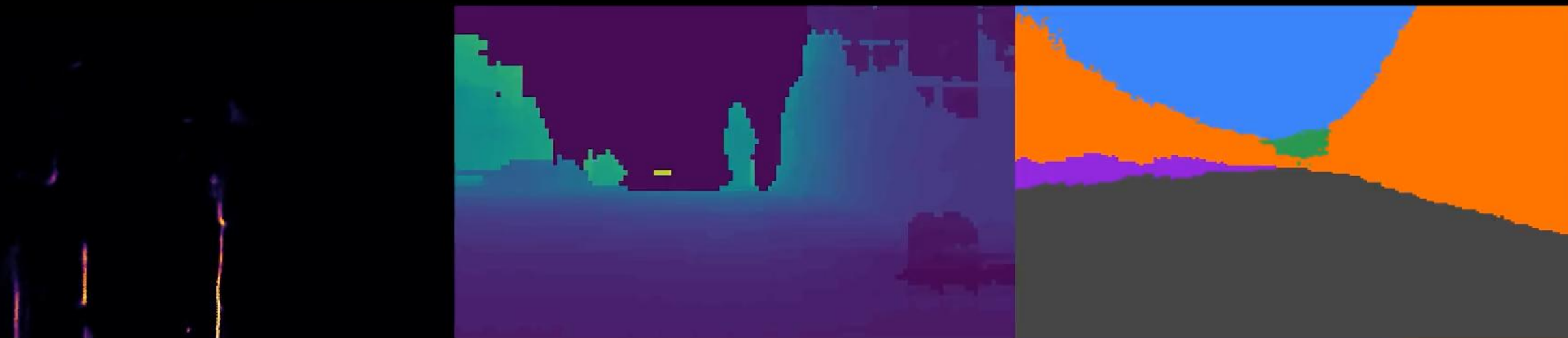
Chip Radar  
3x4 Antenna



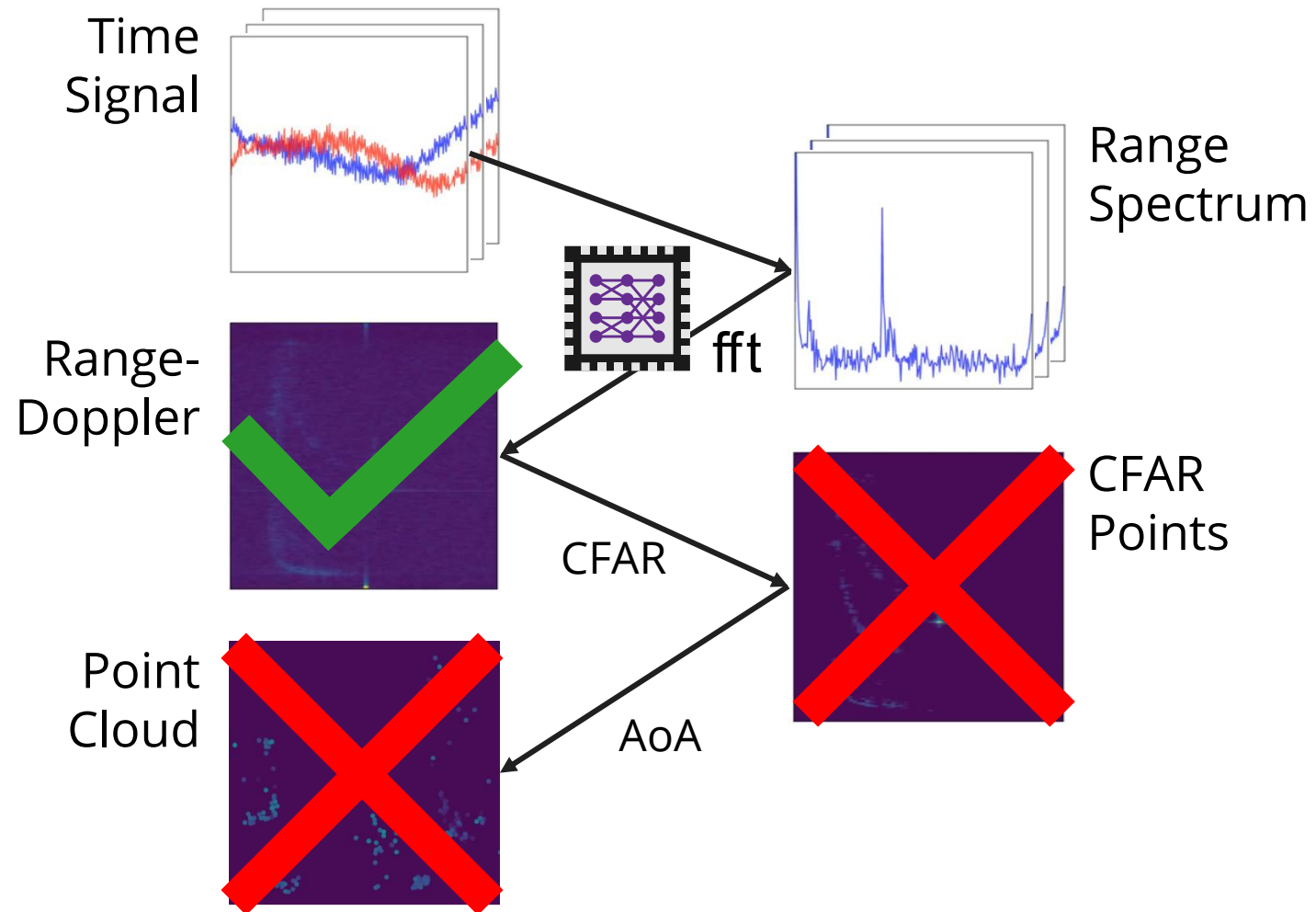
## Reference Scene



## Our GRT Output (Using Only 4D Radar Input)

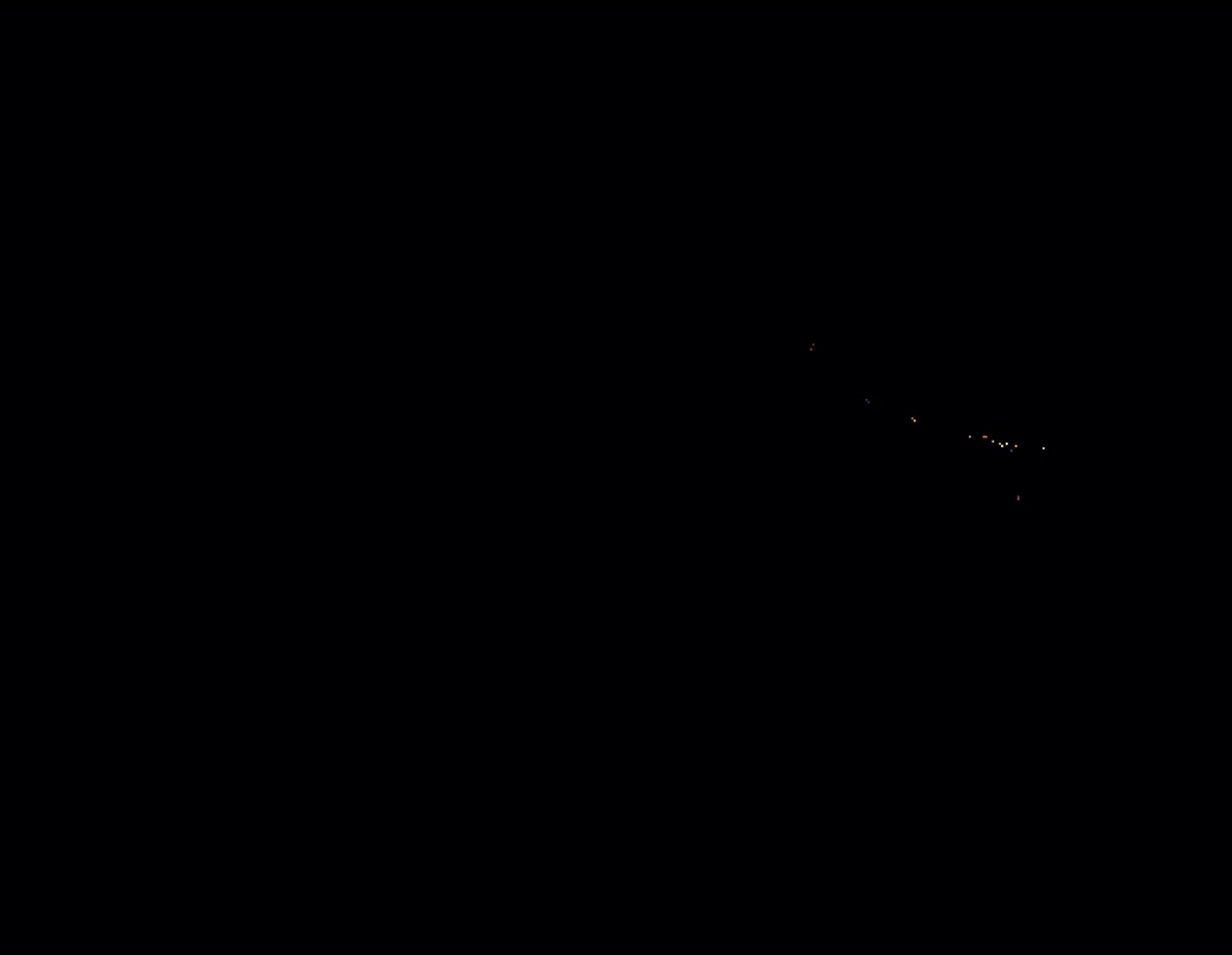


# Key Insight #1: use “raw” unfiltered spectrum

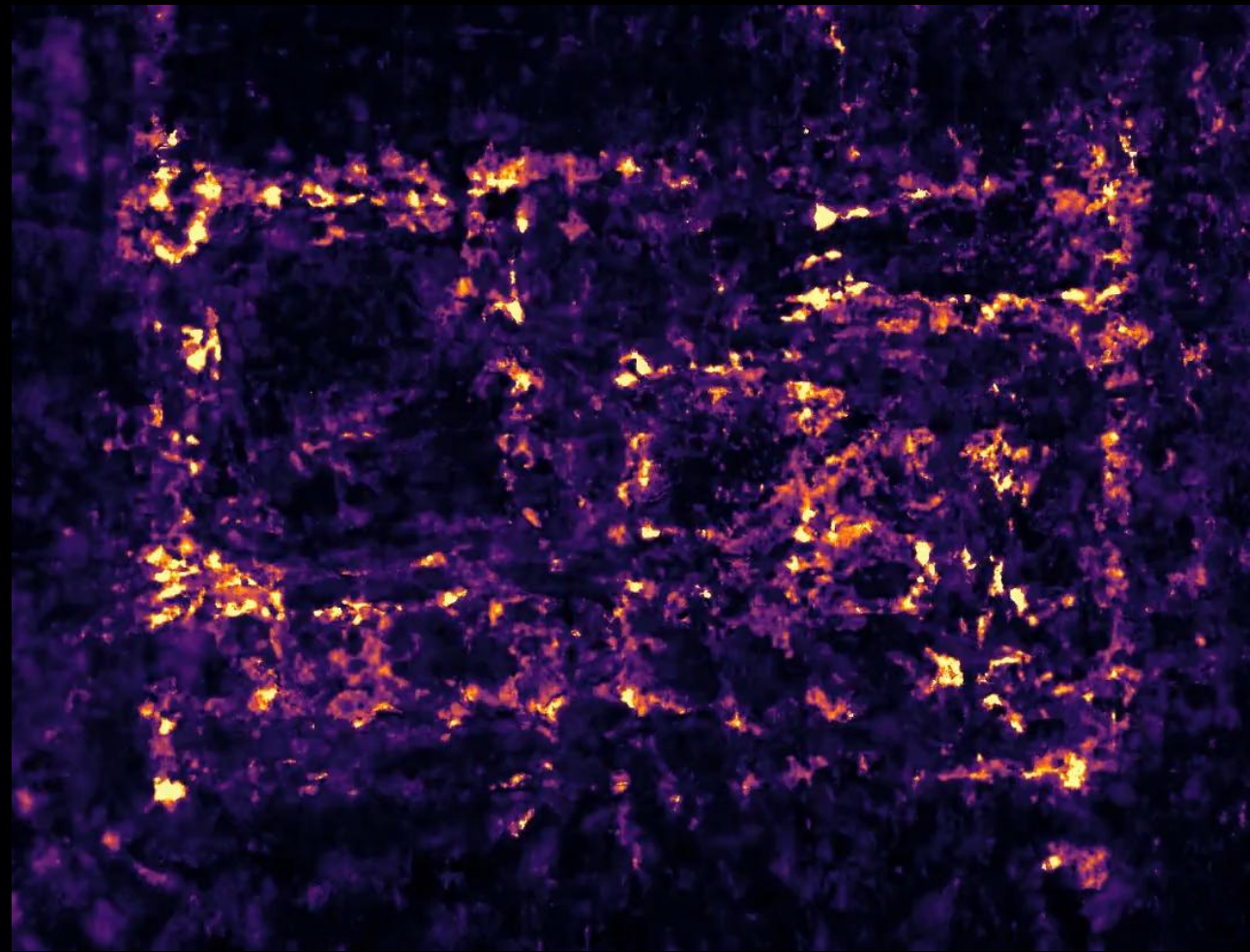




# Key Insight #1: use “raw” unfiltered spectrum

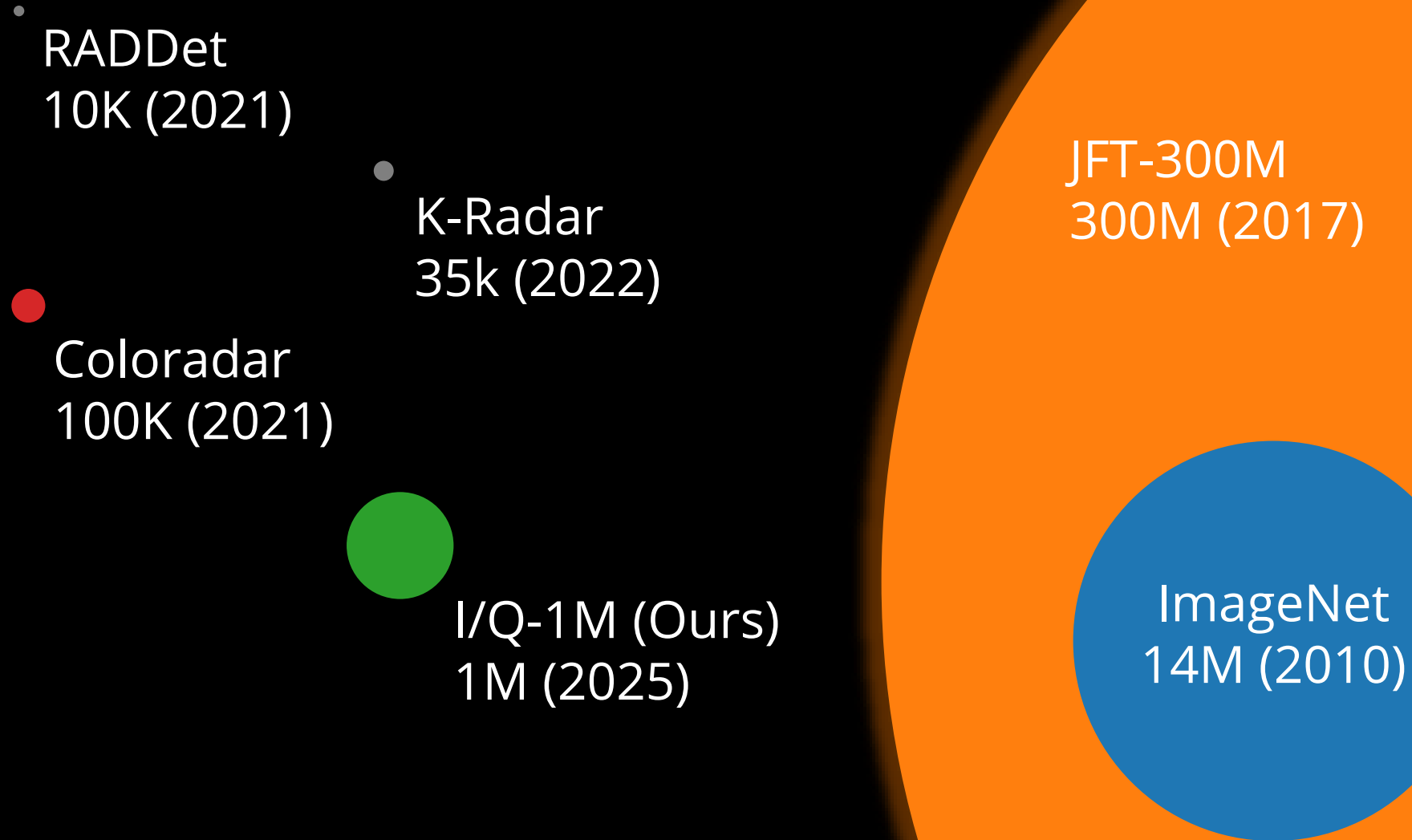


**CFAR** – Point Cloud Aggregation

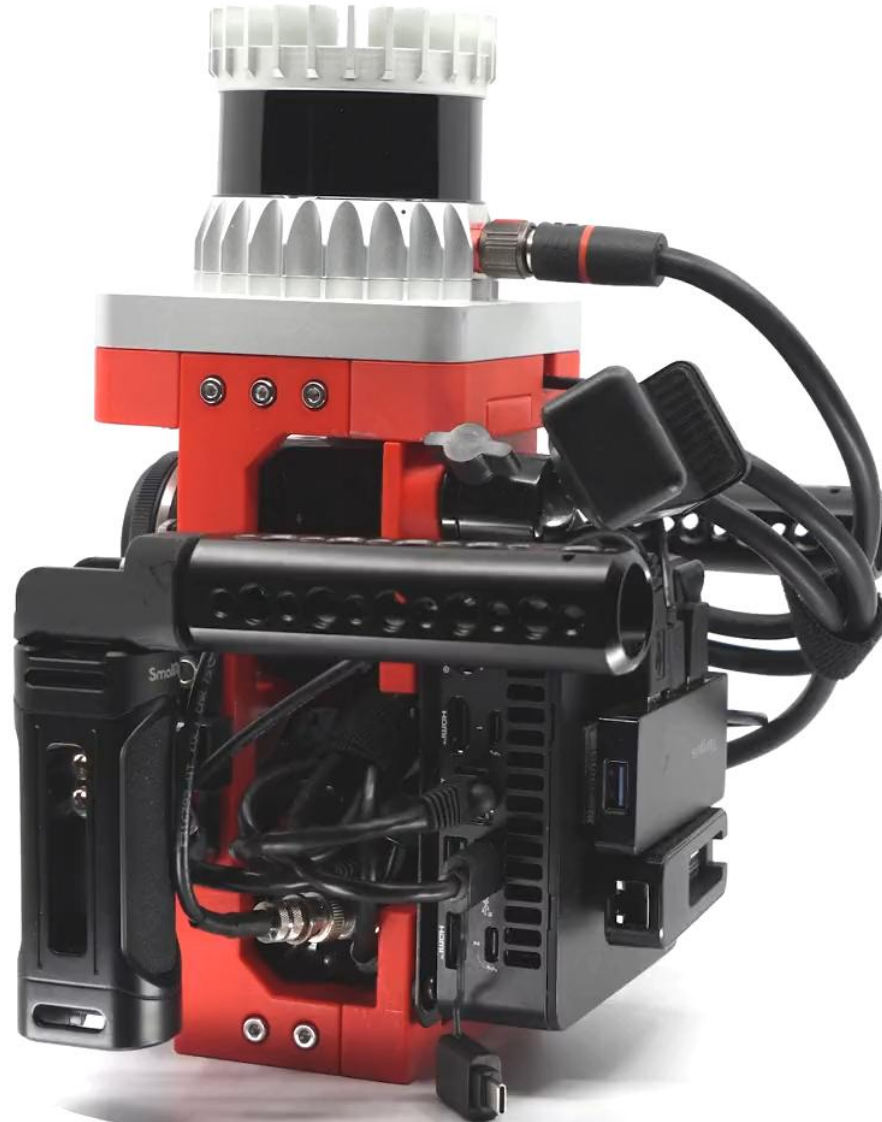


**DART** (CVPR '24) – Dense  
Tomography via Range-Doppler  
Spectrum

# Key Insight #2: **collect more data**



So we started scaling...





# I/Q-1M Dataset





# I/Q-1M Dataset





# I/Q-1M Dataset





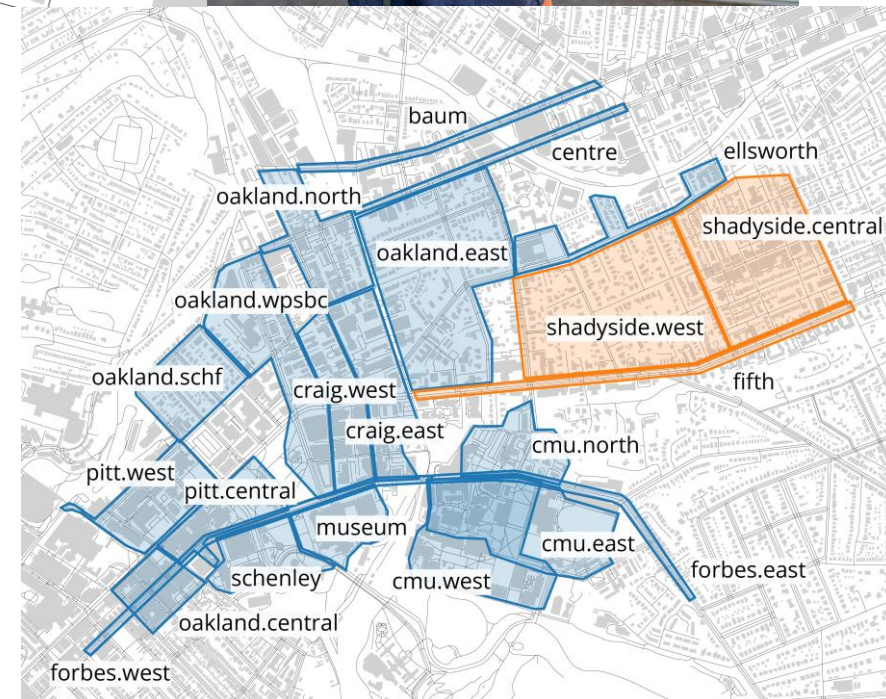
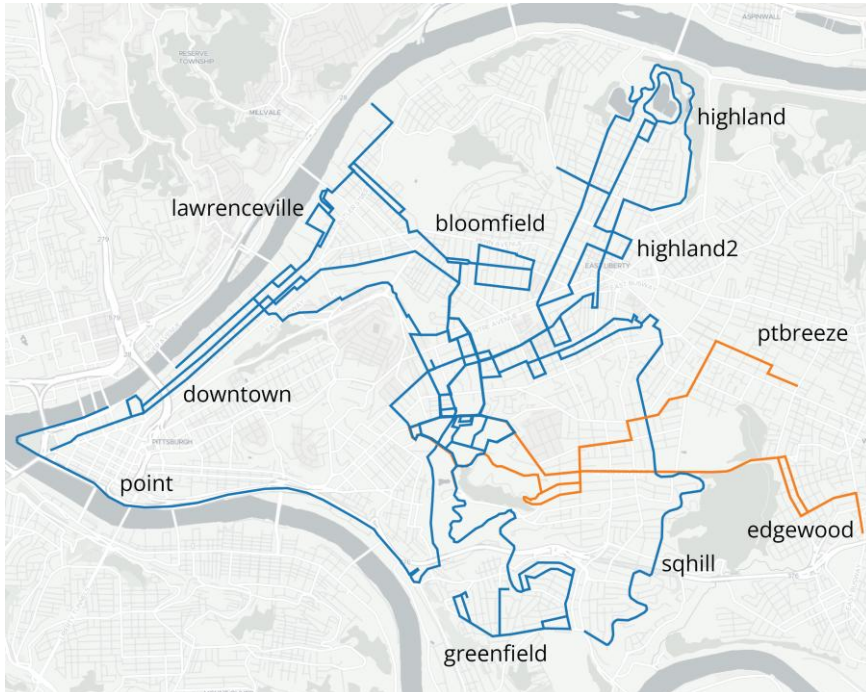
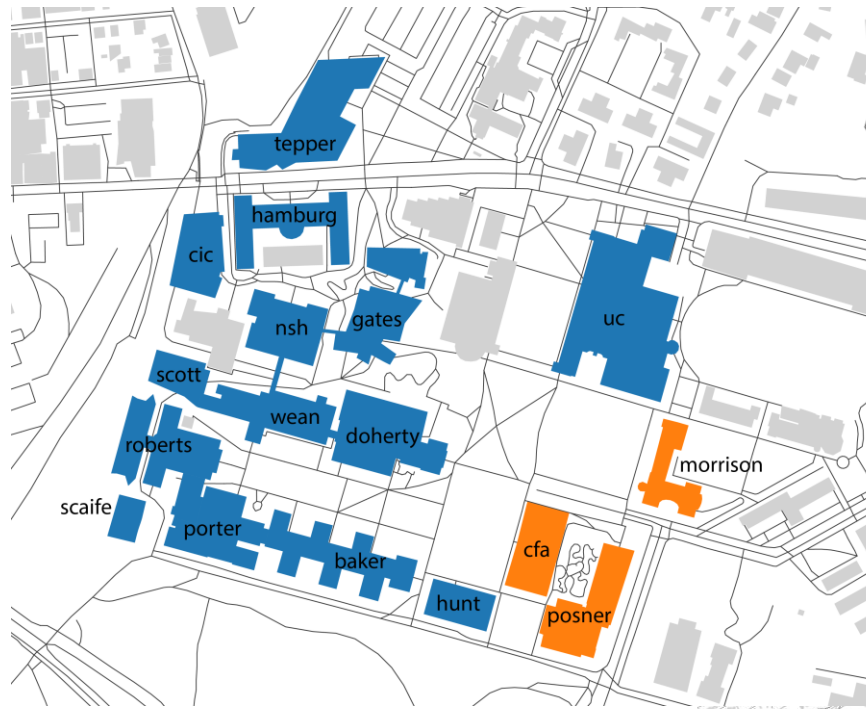
# I/Q-1M Dataset





# I/Q-1M Dataset

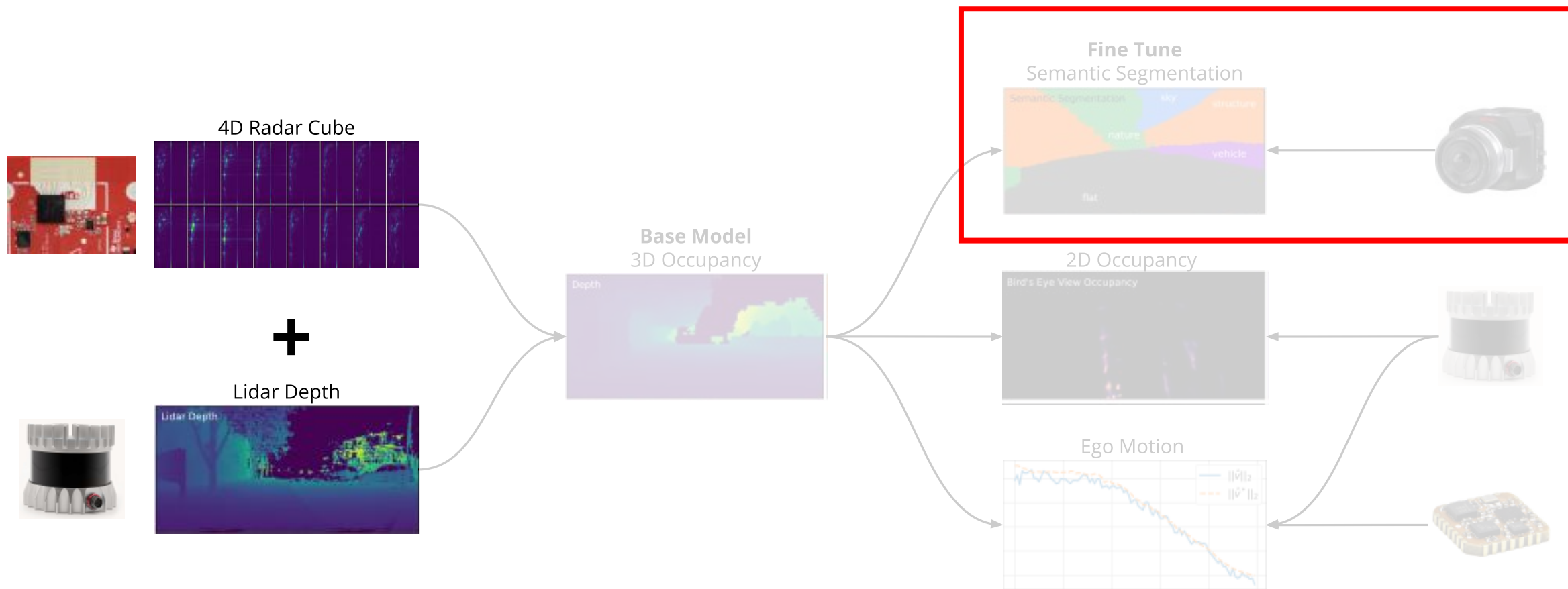
- 29 hours of data
- 1M radar-lidar-camera samples





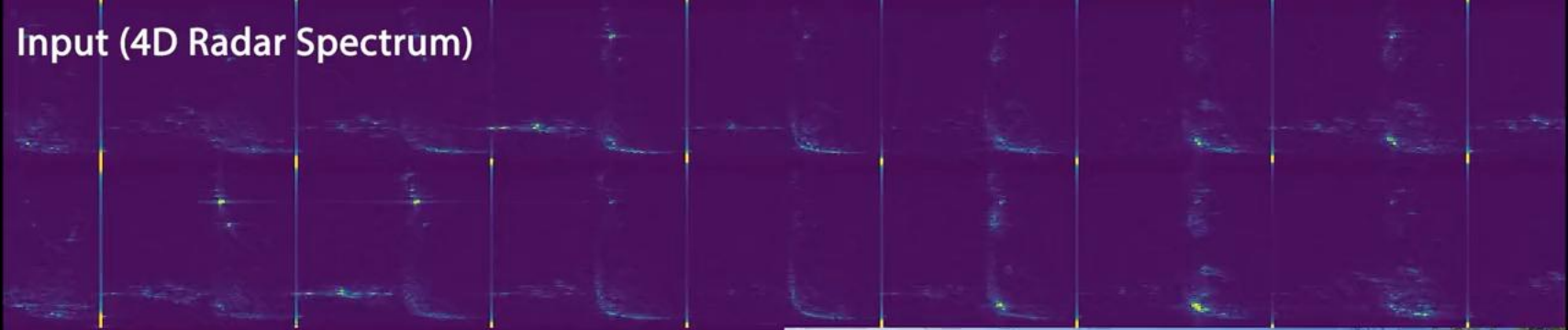


# Generalizable Radar Transformer



GRT Small IQ-1M  
bike/ ptbreeze.back  
+00:52.93s  
radar 001077  
lidar 000550  
camera 001689

Input (4D Radar Spectrum)



Birds Eye View Occupancy (CFAR)



Birds Eye View Occupancy (GRT)



Birds Eye View Occupancy (Lidar)



Depth (CFAR)



Depth (GRT)



Occupancy (Lidar)



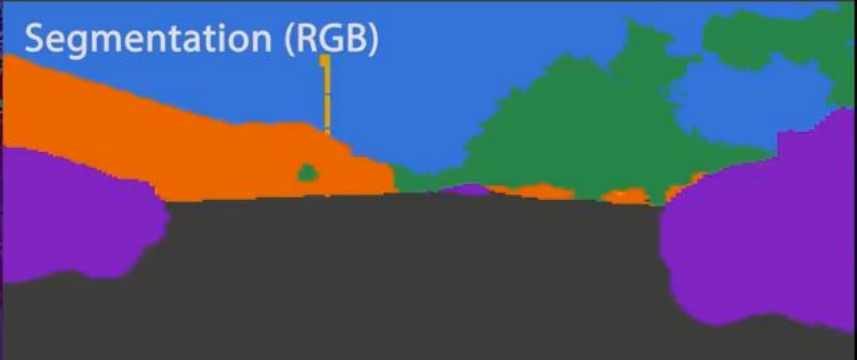
RGB (Ground Truth)



Segmentation (GRT)



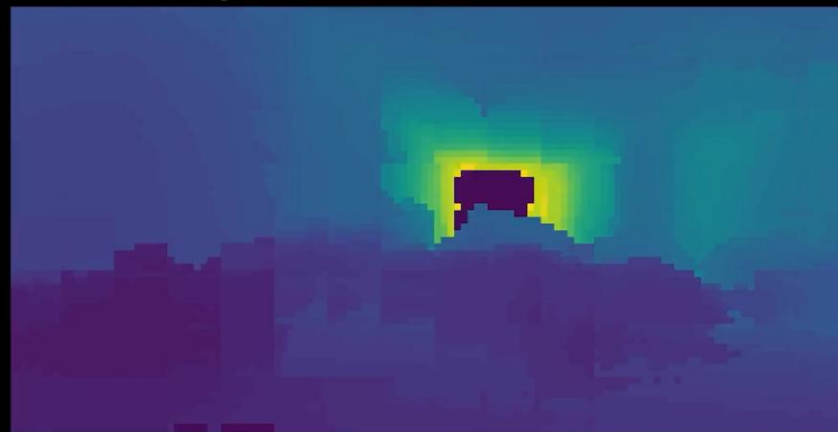
Segmentation (RGB)







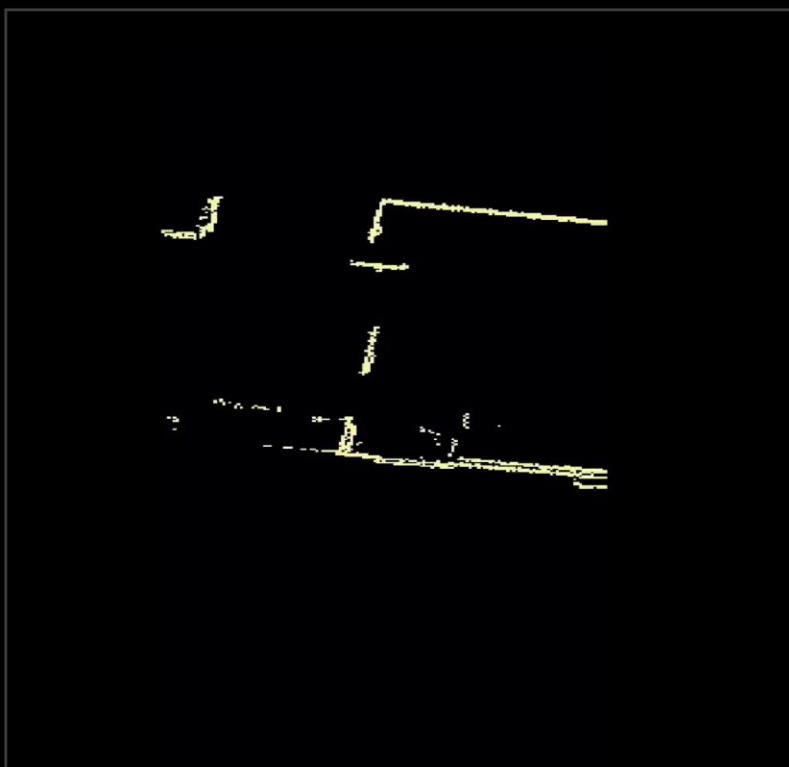
GRT Depth



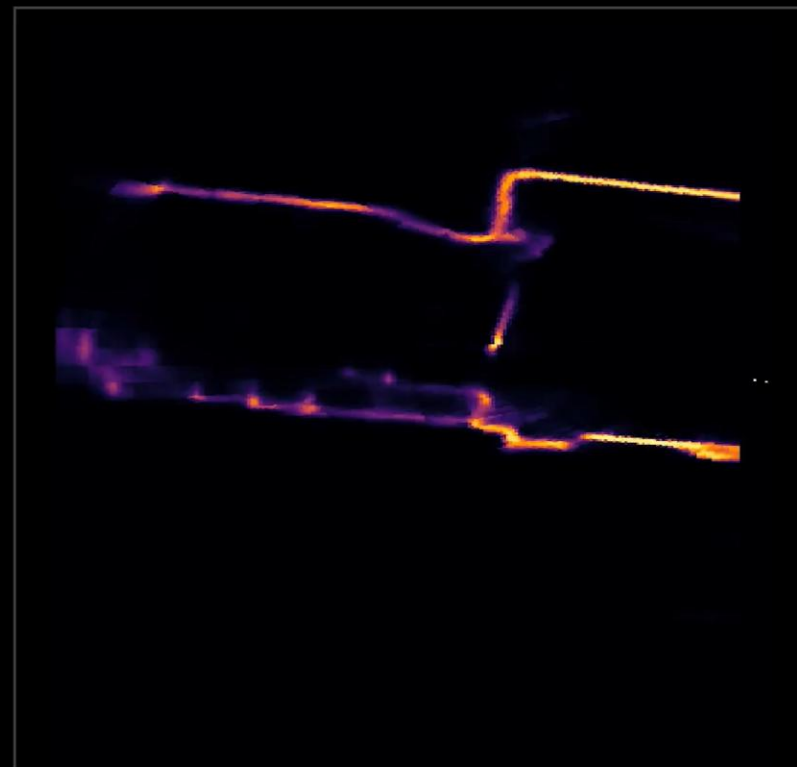
Traditional Point Cloud



Lidar



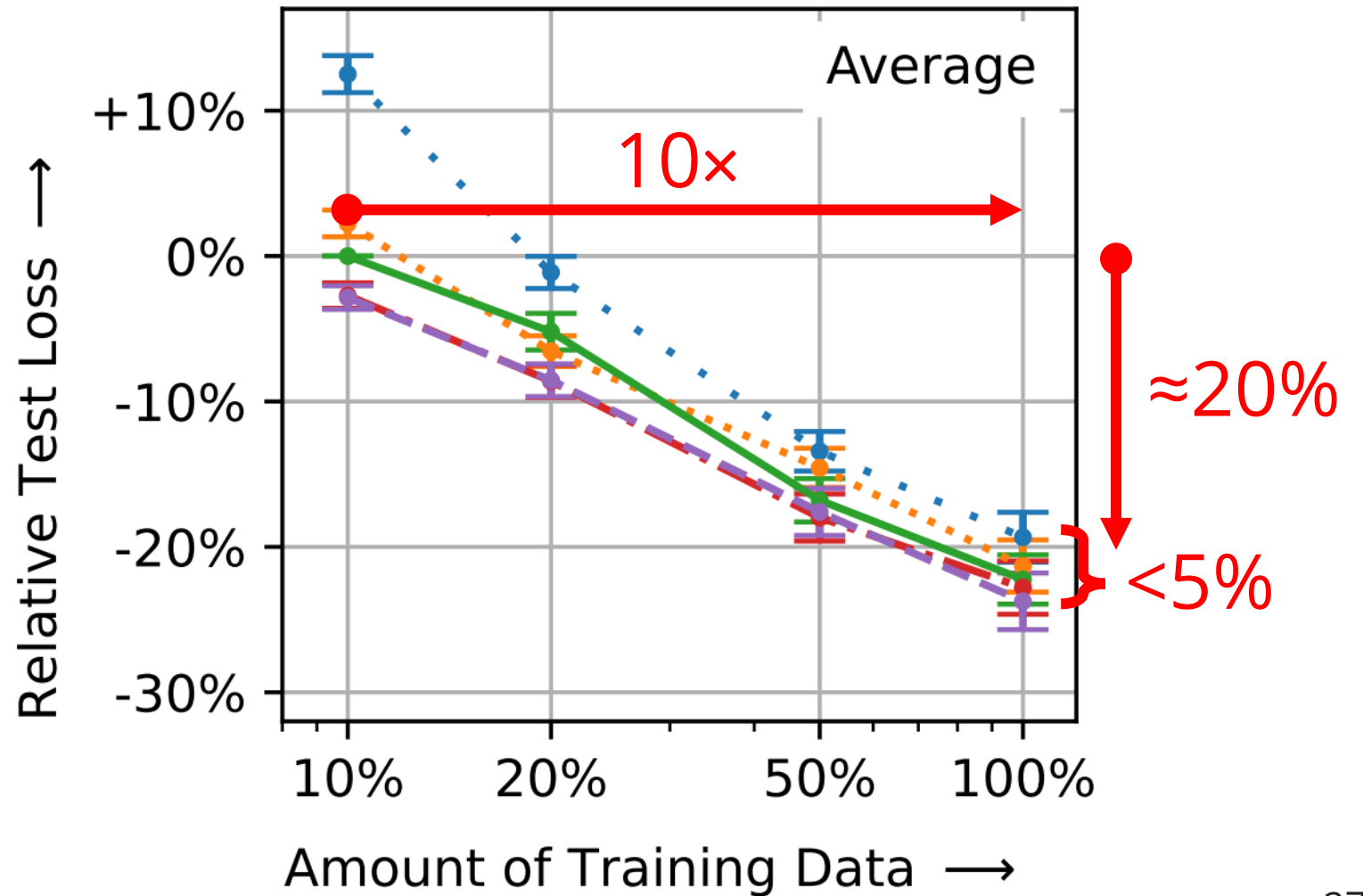
GRT Birds Eye View



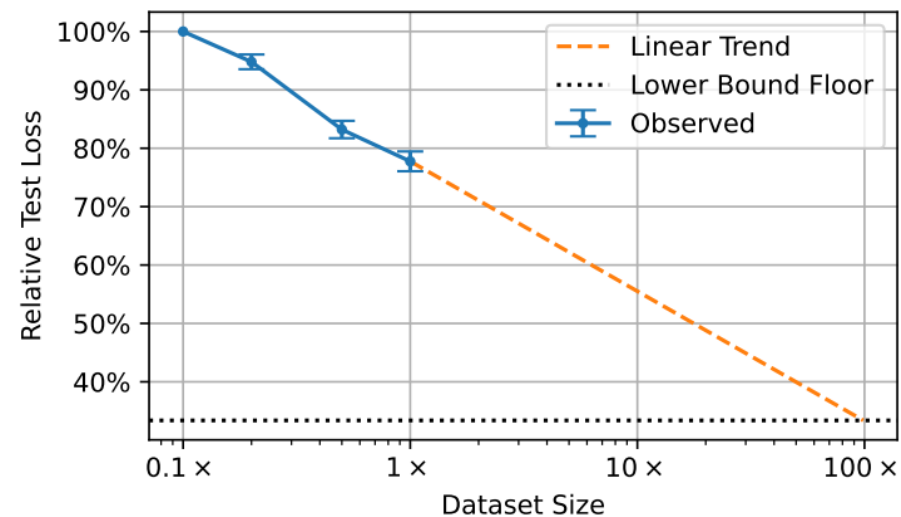
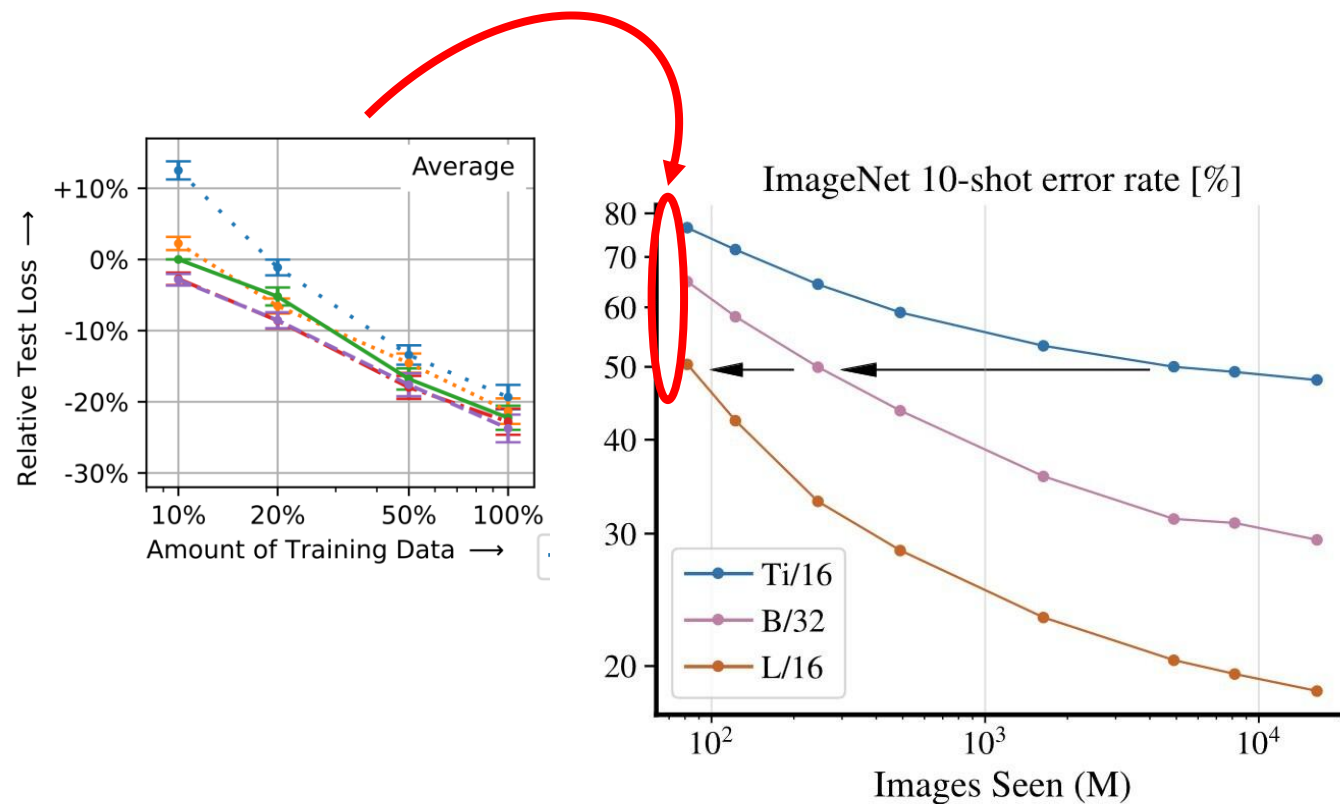
# Key Results: **Logarithmic Scaling**

... but no model size scaling

- Pico (4M)
- Tiny (13M)
- Small (29M)
- Medium (69M)
- Large (150M)



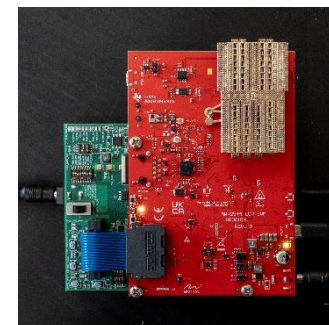
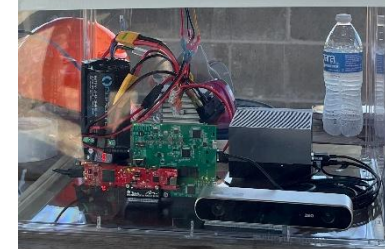
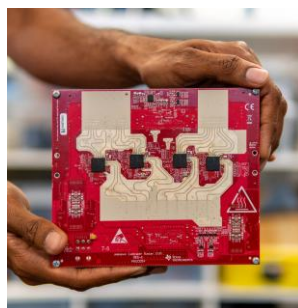
# Key Results: ~~Towards~~ Foundational Models?





# What Next? **Keep Scaling!**

- More sensors
- More settings
- More data



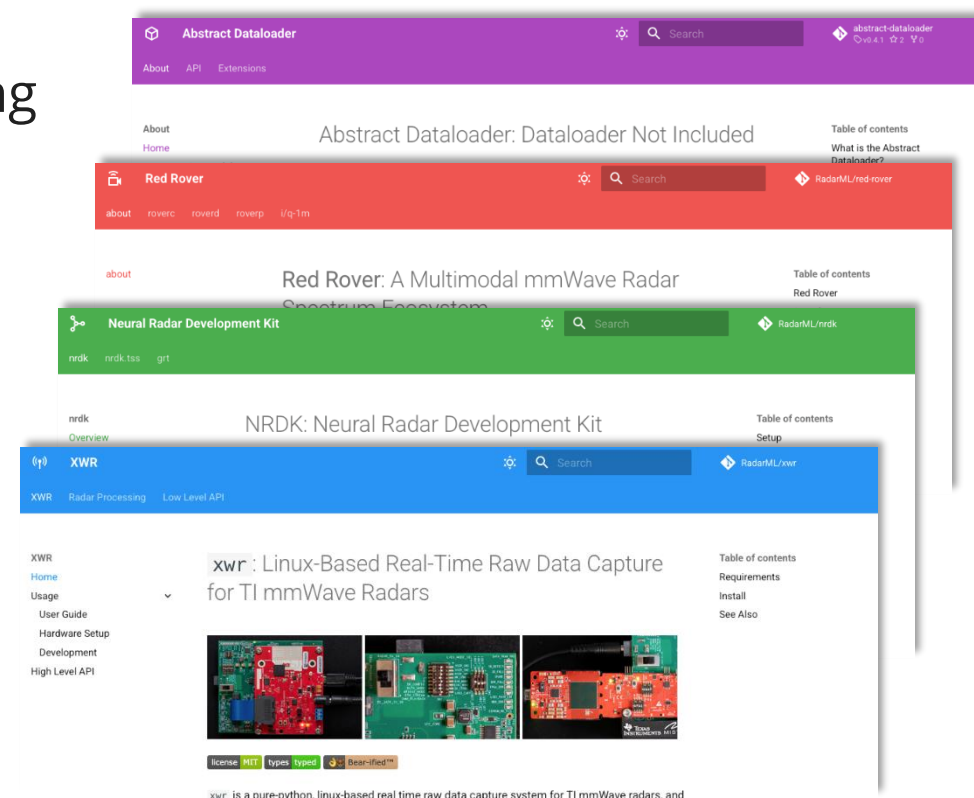
Please reach out if interested!  
*tianshu2@andrew.cmu.edu*

# What Next? The RadarML Ecosystem

- Full research ecosystem for learning on radar spectrum
- Tools, datasets, libraries ...
- Permissively licensed

Please reach out if interested!

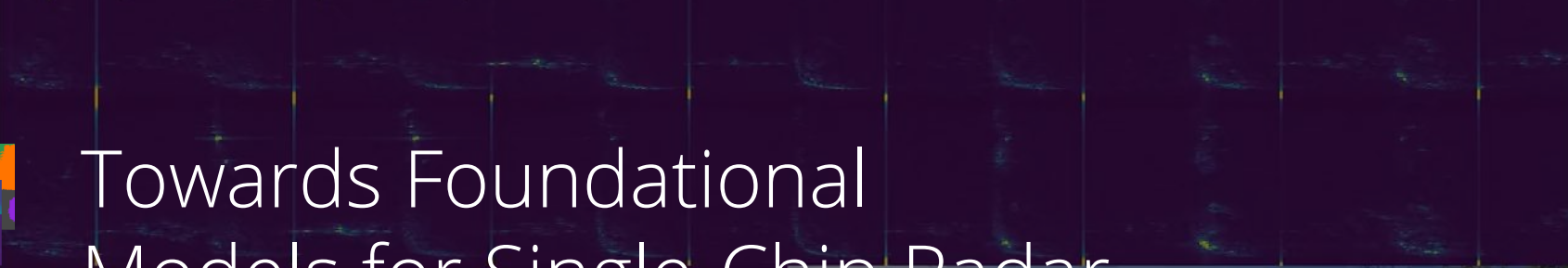
*tianshu2@andrew.cmu.edu*



GRT Small IQ-1M  
bike/ptbreeze.back  
+00:52.93s  
radar 001077  
lidar 000550  
camera 001689



Input (4D Radar Spectrum)

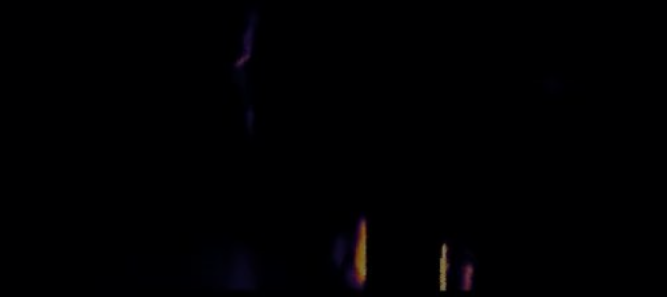


# Towards Foundational Models for Single-Chip Radar

Birds Eye View Occupancy (CFAR)



Birds Eye View Occupancy (GRT)



Birds Eye View Occupancy (Lidar)



Depth (CFAR)



Project Site

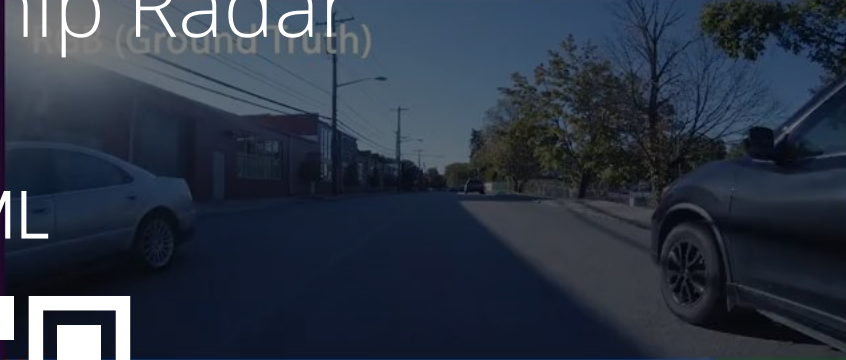


[wiselabcmu.github.io/gtr](https://wiselabcmu.github.io/gtr)

RadarML



[radarml.github.io](https://radarml.github.io)



Segmentation (GRT)



Segmentation (RGB)

